

The problem with capitalism, as presented in manifestation of the landscape of the technology sector.

I saw an article talking about the first major software bug that caused a rippling effect in 1995 at AT&T costing them approximately 60m\$ in losses. It got me thinking...

Capitalism drives stock value above all else, and we crossed the ethical line long ago. Almost all management pretty much accepts that they have to run their companies this way to even be able to maintain being competitive, so it's a self-reinforcing process.

And yes, it's now considered normal to release buggy code with the expectation that we can just "clean things up later."

Wow, sure sounds a lot like every other problem in our society... climate change, etc.

But returning to my original point. We've begun a boiling frog effect. We continue to normalize bigger and bigger failures, and somehow our culture has marketed this all in a way to the general public where most people just hand wave problems away now, even going as far as blaming the problems on technology itself. "I hate it when my phone does x."

Your phone isn't doing x to you, a programmer designed the phone to do y, and x was an unintended consequence that wasn't...

1. Understood properly by the developer
2. Caught in the QA process
3. Was possibly considered, but analyzed to see if the risk was worth delaying timelines. I feel like at this point we arrive at the equation presented in Fight Club. If the potential loss of profit outweighs the risk of losing customers that we've been able to normalize into expecting some failures, then we don't delay.

And we have arrived at our current problem.

Capitalism presents this fundamental trait:

Money is more important than people.

Hell we fought a civil war against this idea and won, but look at us now anyway.

I want to extend this idea that capitalism represents our base humanity.

Thinking in terms of the concept of free will, our brain often short cuts our decision making process (instead of always analyzing the situation to its most extreme way versus all previous data to evaluate the optimal situation, we've always summarized all our of previous data into a "feeling" and we use these feelings to make our decisions - But the feelings are generalizations we've formulated to quicken the feedback process), and possibly capitalism can be thought of an extension of this process. It shortcuts the correct process, for a quicker, more positive outcome in the present, without consideration or regard for the future. And so far, as a species this has carried us to where we are today, so although the process may be deeply flawed from a moral and logical standpoint, its continued success may be a higher level manifestation of our struggle against entropy, and may underlie it as the process that has taken us this far.